M.A. (Previous), Examination, March-April : 2026

ENGLISH LITERATURE

(Poetry)

Paper - I

Time : Three Hours] [*Maximum Marks* : 100

Note : Answer **all** questions. The figures in the righthand margin indicate marks.

Unit - I

1. Explain with reference to context any five of the following passages : $5 \times 4 = 20$

a) Ther was also a nonne, a prioresse,
That of hir smylyng was full of symplo and coy;
Hire gretteste ooth was but Seint Loy,
And she was cleped Madame Eglentyne,
Ful weel she soong the service dyvyne.

b) Oh thoughtless mortals! Ever blind to fate,
Too soon dejected, and too soon elate!
Sudden, these honours shall be snatched away,
And cursed for ever this victorious day.

c) Shall I compare thee to a summer's day?
Thou art more lovely and more temperate:
Rough winds do shake the darling buds of May,
And summer's lease hath all too short a date;

d) All is not lost; the unconquerable Will,
And study of revenge, immortal hate,
And courage never to submit or yield:
And what is else not to be overcome?

e) But oh! that deep romantic chasm which slanted
Down the green hill athwart a cedarn cover!
A savage place! as holy and enchanted
As e'er beneath a waning moon was haunted
By woman wailing for her demon lover!

f) Such stuff
Was courtsey, she thought, and cause enough.
for calling up that spot of joy. She had
A heart – how shall I say? – too soon made glad,
Too easily impressed; she liked whate'er
She looked on, and her looks went everywhere.

g) The black bird, picking food,
See thee, nor stops his meal, nor fears at all;
So often has he known thee past him stray,
Rapt, twirling in thy hand a withered spray,
And waiting for the spark from heaven to fall.

Answer the following questions in 400 words each. $5 \times 16 = 80$

Unit - II

2. Write a note on 'Chaucer's' Prologue to canterbury Tales as a mirror of the 14th century England.

OR

Discuss the theme of Spencer's 'Faerie Queene'.

Unit - III

3. Throw light on the theme of Dark Lady sonnets of Shakespeare.

OR

Discuss John Donne as a metaphysical poet.

OR

Give the character sketch of Satan in "Paradise Lost" Book I.

Unit - IV

4. Discuss John Dryden's 'Absalem and Achitophel' as a political satire.

OR

Discuss 'Rape of the Lock' as a mock-heroic poem.

OR

Write an essay on Gray as a poet.

Unit - V

5. Write a note on Wordsworth as a poet of nature.

OR

Write a critical appreciation of 'Ode to the West Wind'.

OR

Discuss Keats as a writer of Odes.

OR

"Kubla Khan is a poem about poetry and poetic inspiration." Discuss.

Unit - VI

6. Discuss Tennyson as a representative of his age.

OR

List the major characteristics of Dramatic Monologue. Discuss Browning as a master of this form in the light of the poems prescribed in the syllabus.

OR

Discuss 'Scholar Gypsy' as a Pastoral Elegy.